

FOR PRINCIPALS & SUPERINTENDENTS · 3-MINUTE READ

AI for Communication: The message before the message

A 45–60 minute, self-facilitated session on one position: AI's value here is not writing your teachers' hard messages, it is making ordinary positive contact happen at a volume nobody sustains by hand. Every teacher leaves with four notes to four real families and one hard message drafted in their own words.

THE STANCE, AND YOUR PARENT ANSWER

AI handles the ordinary contact. **The teacher still writes the hard message.** Sensitive news is always delivered personally, by voice, and official documents travel district translation channels.

Why this matters now

Family communication lives in the margins of a ~54-hour week (Merrimack/EdWeek, 2022), so the note with no deadline is cut first. What that costs: weekly individualized teacher-to-parent messages cut the share of students failing to earn the course credit from 15.8% to 9.3% (Kraft & Rogers, 2015). That study ran in a summer credit-recovery program and tested a bundle, so no single ingredient is proven to be the active one, and we teach it with that scope attached every time.

What your staff will be able to do afterward

- Run a ten-minute weekly routine that sends four families a note when nothing is wrong
- Use AI for the shape of those notes and supply the one specific true detail themselves
- Write a hard message to four rules: fact first, one ask with a date, no promise that cannot be kept, and know when to call instead
- Use AI on a difficult message for exactly one job, a second read for tone, never the words
- State the human-only list cold: safety, discipline, grief, and special-education news travel by voice
- Keep the privacy rule: situations, never student identities, go into public tools

Research base in brief

Kraft & Rogers (2015), scope stated wherever cited · Merrimack College & EdWeek Research Center (2022) · Gallup & Walton Family Foundation (2025), a self-report · ED/DOJ Dear Colleague Letter (2015) · U.S. Dept. of Education OET (2023). Full APA citations ship in the References file.

Where it fits

Kit 6 of 8 in **Track A: AI Foundations**. Ships with a 30-day plan (three 10-minute PLC follow-ups) and an exit ticket that doubles as PD documentation. Kit 7 (AI for Workload) is next.

Built by Adam & Katelyn Spinozzi, certified educators. © AI-Ready School. Informational, not legal advice; consult district counsel. Check with your district or state whether this PD qualifies for local credit.